

Practice Quiz: Systems — What Makes a Circle a Circle

Part A: Multiple Choice

1. In Active Inference, the **Markov blanket** of a crochet circle is best described as: A) The physical walls of the meeting room B) The social and organizational boundary that separates the circle's internal dynamics from the wider world C) The yarn that connects each member's project D) A list of all members' names and contact information
2. Which of the following is an **internal state** of a crochet circle? A) A new yarn shop opening in town B) A viral crochet pattern trending online C) The shared memory that the group tried Tunisian crochet and found it challenging D) The weather on meeting night
3. A member discovers a new stitch on social media and demonstrates it at the next meeting. This is an example of: A) Internal states directly affecting external states B) External information crossing the Markov blanket through sensory states C) The dissolution of the system boundary D) Self-evidencing by the individual member
4. When a long-time member leaves the circle and the group continues to meet and function, this demonstrates: A) That the member was never truly part of the system B) The system's ability to maintain its identity despite changes in components C) That internal states are not affected by membership changes D) A failure of the Markov blanket
5. Shared pattern books, communal stitch markers, and spare hooks for newcomers are best classified as: A) Internal states only B) External states only C) Blanket states that mediate between internal and external D) Irrelevant to the system analysis
6. A crochet circle is nested within larger systems. Which sequence correctly shows nesting from smallest to largest? A) Global crochet culture > Local yarn shop > Your circle > Individual crocheter B) Individual crocheter > Your circle > Local crafting

community > Global crochet culture C) Your circle > Individual crocheter > Global crochet culture > Local crafting community D) Local crafting community > Your circle > Individual crocheter > Global crochet culture

7. The concept of **self-evidencing** in a crochet circle means: A) The circle produces evidence that crochet is better than knitting B) The circle takes actions that confirm and sustain its own continued existence C) Each member must prove their skill level to belong D) The circle eliminates all prediction error immediately

Part B: Short Answer

1. A brand-new crochet circle has just formed — three friends who decided to meet weekly. Describe what its Markov blanket looks like at this early stage compared to a circle that has been meeting for five years. What internal states has the new circle not yet developed?
2. Your circle decides to welcome a newcomer who has never crocheted before. Describe this event using Active Inference terminology — what sensory states does the circle register, what active states does it deploy, and how do internal states change as the newcomer is integrated?
3. Give a concrete example of how a crochet circle's **active states** influence the external world. How does the circle's internal knowledge or activity change something outside its boundary?